



Aptiv Interview Experience

About Aptiv:

Aptiv is a global technology company that develops safer, greener and more connected solutions, which enable the future of mobility.

Aptiv's passionate team of engineers and developers creates advanced safety systems, high-performance electrification solutions and data connectivity solutions so that automakers can bring advanced capabilities to more people around the globe.

About the Role:

Associate Embedded Software Engineer

There are various roles including software, hardware, and AI/ML. I have been selected for the position of **Software Engineer – PM**. This role involves working on the infotainment systems which we see in the car.

Selection Process:

- Online test
 - Technical interview
 - Techno managerial interview
 - HR interview
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Round 1: Online Assessment

[90 mins]

Round 1 was an online HackerRank assessment. It included a few MCQs from core subjects like dbms,os,oops. Apart from the MCQs, there were two questions. For some candidates, both questions were coding problems, with one being mandatory in C and the other allowed in any programming language. For others, like me, there was one coding question and one SQL question. The coding problem was of medium difficulty, and the SQL question had to be solved using window functions.

Round 2: Technical Interview

[50 mins]

All the interview rounds were conducted online.

In my second round, which was the technical interview, I was asked questions from multiple domains. The interview began with a coding question based on LeetCode Problem 3: Longest Substring Without Repeating Characters. After that, I was asked to write a basic SQL query involving a JOIN. The interviewer

provided the table names and attributes, and I had to write the query. I was also asked conceptual questions related to primary keys and foreign keys and how they are used in different scenarios.

Next, the discussion moved to computer networks and security, where I was asked about HTTPS and how certificates are received and validated. This led to questions on cryptography, including symmetric key encryption, asymmetric key encryption, and hashing, along with examples for each.

Overall, the interview lasted for about 50 minutes and covered a wide range of technical topics.

Round 3: Techno managerial interview [35 mins]

In the techno-managerial round, the discussion was mainly based on my resume and the projects I had worked on. I spoke about a project related to autonomous vehicles, and the interviewer asked me to explain it in detail. He also discussed my second project mentioned in the resume and asked follow-up questions about it.

In addition, I was asked behavioral questions, including whether any conflicts had occurred within my team. I described a real situation where a conflict arose and explained how I handled it in my role as a leader.

Overall, this round was focused on understanding my attitude, values, teamwork, leadership skills, and decision-making approach, rather than purely technical knowledge.

Round 4: HR Discussion

[15 mins]

The interviews were originally planned to be conducted over two days. However, in my case, the process extended to a third day, which was actually a holiday, and only five members had their interviews on that day. Usually, the interviews are completed within two days.

Some candidates may start and even complete their HR round on the first day itself, while others might not have even started their technical rounds by then. So it is important to wait patiently and stay calm throughout the process. In my case, I was the last person to attend the HR discussion. My technical interview happened on the second day in the evening, and the techno-managerial round was conducted on the second day at around 7 PM. The final interview took place the next day, even though it was not part of the original schedule.

It is also important to note that there can be rejections even in the HR round at Aptiv. So, be confident in the way you speak and maintain good communication skills, as these play a crucial role

in clearing the HR round. Additionally, having a good understanding of the company and asking relevant, company-related questions to the interviewer can leave a positive impression. After 5 days the results are out and 25 of us is selected from different backgrounds for different roles.

My Preparation Strategy:

I focused on general preparation by practicing LeetCode problems and HackerRank SQL questions. I followed Striver's DSA sheet and referred to YouTube videos to strengthen my understanding of data structures and algorithms. I revised core concepts using GeeksforGeeks, including OOPS. For Operating Systems, I studied from the Neso Academy YouTube channel, and for DBMS, I referred to Jenny's Lectures.

Key Suggestions and Tips from My Experience:

Do not feel pressured by seeing others get placed early. Everyone's journey is different, and your opportunity will come at the right time. There is no such thing as being "too late" — what matters is consistent effort and patience. Focus mainly on strengthening your data structures and core concepts, as they form the foundation for most technical interviews.

Also, be honest with your resume. Do not include anything that you are not confident about or cannot explain clearly. Make sure you understand every line you write, because interviewers can ask questions from any part of it. Stay focused, keep practicing, and trust the process.

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